THINK. LISTEN. RESPECT.

EST. 2004

FUNDING PROPOSAL

OF THE

THETHANI DEBATING LEAGUE

Public Benefit Organisation (PBO) registration number:
070000190

Ubunye (parent organisation) NPO registration number:
061-733-NPO

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Thethani Debating League (TDL) is an entirely student-run project that forms a part of our parent organisation, Ubunye. Ubunye is a Development Agency and a registered Public Benefit Organisation, operating out of the University of Cape Town (UCT). TDL operates entirely thanks to the time and effort put in by volunteers from UCT. In the pre-Covid era it also included volunteers from the Cape Peninsula University of Technology (CPUT), Stellenbosch University, and the University of Western Cape (UWC). Our focus lies in bringing valuable *critical thinking, public speaking, language and persuasion skills* to under-resourced schools throughout the townships surrounding Cape Town. TDL, the largest outreach debating league in South Africa, reaches 10 schools and over 100 learners every week, providing high quality weekly coaching workshops and competitive weekend tournaments throughout the school year.

For the learners we serve, the practical implications of the skills we foster are significant: Higher motivation and achievement in school, acing a job interview, *critically analysing the realities of life as a current South African youth as well as encouraging active citizenship*. Meta-analytical research demonstrates the tangible benefits that debating brings to students. Akerman and Neale (2011), in a comprehensive review of the social impact of debating, found that when involved in high school debating, children were more likely to do better in their schoolwork (Akerman, R. & Neale, I., 2011. 'Debating the evidence: an international review of current situation and perceptions'. *CfBT Education Trust.*). Students state that debating has significantly improved their English, the medium we practice through, something which will help them both in school and in the job market. Our program encourages thinking critically about the inequalities of the past, beyond what students might learn in school or from their peers or parents. We aim at helping underprivileged young people to navigate various *critical social themes* and to produce their own views about South African society. TDL has been nurturing these skills throughout the townships of Cape Town for 20 consecutive years.

As an entity that has expressed an interest in championing the active citizenship and education of South African youth, we appeal to you to help fund their continued growth as individuals and citizens. As committed and driven volunteer students, we strive to uphold the highest standard of debating and improve the abilities of our pupils with your assistance we hope to carry on the legacy of TDL far into the future, developing its impact and reach.

OUR SCHOOLS

For your interest, the schools we work with, categorised by area, are listed below:

Khayelitsha:

- Luhlaza Secondary School

Heideveld:

- Heideveld Secondary School

Gugulethu:

- I.D. Mkize Senior Secondary School
- Fezeka Secondary School
- New Eisleben High School

Mfuleni:

- Mfuleni Secondary School

Samora Machel:

- Sophumelela High School
- Zisukhanyo Secondary School

Langa:

- Khulani Secondary School
- LEAP
- Isilimela High School

WHAT WE DO

Bi-Weekly Workshops

The schools listed above receive bi-weekly training workshops. These are facilitated by TDL volunteers at UCT Upper Campus. (In the past, we were able to provide transport for the volunteers to and from the school directly, however this is no longer the case.) The workshops are a collaborative learning space. While we do use this time to teach the rules and technicalities of debating, most often these are focus-group-type sessions in which the coach and the learners talk about pertinent global or local issues and events and develop ways to engage with these issues critically. These topics of discussion might range from rape culture or the legacy of colonialism to feminism and democracy. We hope that through these discussions' learners develop the ability to think critically about the world around them and actively engage with the issues that face them, their communities and our country.

Tournaments

All 10 of our schools are invited to come together to compete in the weekend tournaments. These usually take place twice a term depending on the availability of resources. The tournaments operate in two separate leagues: The juniors (teams made up of only Grade 8 and 9 learners) and the seniors (teams made up of only Grade 10, 11 and 12 learners). Typically, we host 3 rounds of debates on one tournament day (which runs from about 08h00 to 17h00). For each round of the tournament, teams are paired off to debate against each other on a particular topic - one team arguing *for* the motion and the other *against*. These topics might range anywhere from the legality of prostitution, the voting age, issues of South African governance, and even the morals of vegetarianism! Sometimes we host 'themed' tournaments, where all the topics for all 3 rounds follow a certain topic (e.g. international relations, feminism, democracy, etc.)

At the end of the tournament day, we usually announce the top 3 schools (in both leagues) and the top 3 individual speakers (in both leagues). These award-winners are presented with a certificate (and sometimes a chocolate) to recognise their achievements. Learners are provided with lunch during the tournament (a roll, a fruit, a juice, a packet of chips and a chocolate) and then are given R50 each at the end of the day to subsidise the cost of transporting themselves to and from the tournament.

WHY PARTNER WITH US?

Central to TDL's vision as a community outreach organisation is to promote and cultivate not only debating skills, but also critical thinking and active citizenship of the youth of South Africa. Although the focus of the organisation is debating, we view this simply as a means to an end rather than the end itself. On this basis TDL uses debating as a tool through which we aim to encourage and foster critical thinking skills, active citizenship, general knowledge, public speaking and confidence in our learners. Through our debating programme TDL's aim is to inspire our learners to think critically about what is happening in their communities as well as the country more generally and in so doing encouraging them to practically engage with their circumstances.

We can run tournaments that specifically focus on the issues pertinent to the ideas of the sponsoring organisation, building your brand and developing the community. At these tournaments the motions posed to the learners that engage them in questions about identity, corruption, ubuntu, mental health, safety and security, voting, public service, accountability, protests, education etc. Additionally, building up to the tournament, TDL could hold training sessions in which the aforementioned issues are discussed and explored with the guidance of a coach.

Furthermore, if a tournament were sponsored, TDL would welcome a representative of the organisation to talk to the learners and express its interests. This could happen after the learners have registered for the tournament but before the debates begin enabling the learners to structure arguments in this fashion.

HOW YOU CAN PARTNER WITH US: OVERVIEW

TDL works on the basis that any and all donations are welcome from donors, whether this comes in form of financial support, donations in kind or putting our organisation in touch with other potential donors. However, donors have the autonomy to decide to participate in funding specific schemes. Importantly, TDL is open to receiving 'partial' sponsorship where certain expenses are covered and not others. In other words, TDL does not take the position of 'all or nothing' but is open to flexibility depending on the position of the donor.

- General funding: Funding that goes towards all TDL expenses.
    - This would be in the form of a cash donation to TDL.
        - A donation of **R55 000** would cover our expenses for the 2025 program.

- Tournament-specific funding: Funding a tournament with motions centred around a general topic the donor would like to address
    - TDL aims to host a tournament about 2-3 times a year.
    - The tournament will be themed around issues relevant to the organisation.
    - At a tournament, the organisation is welcome to host a presentation to the learners.
    - Sponsorship would take the form of supplying funding for food, transport, and certificates/prizes for learners.

- Workshop-specific funding: Funding a specific days/week/weeks/months of workshops to the students on a particular topic
    - In terms of a partnership with your organisation, this would entail preparing training material that focuses on issues relevant to its ideals. Collaboration is welcome.
    - The extent of sponsorship is entirely up to the financial capacity of the organisation, every bit helps. So, this could mean sponsorship of only one day of workshops or alternatively two months of workshops, for example
    - Because the only costs incurred for weekly training is transport, sponsorship would be in the form of supplying funding for transport or supplying the transport directly

- School-specific Funding: Funding for a specified period of time to one specific school to cover all of their expenses
    - This would include covering TDL's expenses on behalf of a specific school. I.e. covering the costs of transport to a specific school for training workshops or covering the costs of food of a specific school at tournaments.
    - The idea is to encourage learners to engage with TDL and reap the benefits of TDL advocacy at the school's workshops.

- Service/product-specific funding: Funding that is only used towards one specific expense that TDL incurs. E.g. Transport only, catering only
    - This would be the 'partial' funding noted above, where based on the organisations financial constraints sponsorship is directed towards specific expenses and thus not the sponsorship of an entire tournament or an entire week of workshops.
    - An alternative is to fund TDL products, such as T-shirts. We distribute T-shirts to committee members to encourage solidarity and make us noticeable at tournaments and recruitment events. In the past, committee T-shirts have had our sponsor's logo emblazoned on the sleeve.

HOW YOU CAN PARTNER WITH US: COSTS OF POTENTIAL SPONSORSHIP

TDL's operation comprises both bi-weekly debating training workshops and weekend tournaments. The vast majority of the yearly budget goes towards facilitating these two categories of activities. TDL would be thrilled with sponsorship that provided funds for any combination of workshops, tournaments, or overhead costs. This section includes a snapshot of each expense item, as well as more detailed descriptions below.
TDL is by no means bound to these strict structures; if a specific partnership for one, smaller tournament of perhaps 70 learners is desired with a focus on elections and the democratic process, this would be

very willingly received. The costs presented in this section are indicative of our current spending patterns, but not a directive on specific funding options; *any support will be graciously accepted***.**

Summarized Expenses

TDL spends;

- R 6 800 on a typical day's worth of weekend tournament that provides an exciting day of debating, lunch and transport reimbursement to the approximately 120 learners in attendance.
- R 11 400 on a large tournament of the same nature, with 200 learners in attendance.
- R 1 800 on a week's worth of debating training workshops, with the learners travelling to our campus for training.
- R 2500 a year on volunteer socials that allow TDL to showcase its appreciation for our volunteers and expand our volunteer base among young people at universities.
- R 1500 on snazzy committee T-shirts that are both a marketing tool (we have had our sponsor's logo on the shirts in the past) and useful for learners to identify committee members at tournaments.

Tournament Budget Breakdown

A TDL tournament budget comprises two main pools of expense. First, there is the cost of transport; TDL provides R50 in cash to learners who attend the tournament as a reimbursement for travel to the tournament venue, and provides a bus for the adjudicators to and from the tournament. Second, there is the cost of lunch, which is provided to learners, adjudicators and the committee. In addition, tea, coffee and the all-important biscuits are provided for adjudicators, and a gift is given to the school who hosts the tournament, though these costs are small overall.

The breakdown is listed below for a typical TDL tournament, broken into an average tournament in which TDL typically invites 120 learners, and a large tournament, in which TDL invites 200 learners.

Number of Learners	Cost of Transport per Learner	Cost of Lunch Pack per learner	Total for Tournament
50 (Average)	R 50	R 35	R 4 250
100 (Large)	R 50	R 35	R 8 500
Number of Adjudicators and Committee Members	**Cost of Transport (Bus for adjudicators)**	**Cost of Lunch Pack per Adjudicator and Committee Member**	
10 (Average)	R 1 750	R 35	R 2 100
20 (Large)	R 1 750	R 35	R 2 450
	Cost of Tea, Coffee and Biscuits	**Cost of Gift for School**	
	R 350	R 150	R 450
Total for Entire Tournament (Average in Learner Numbers)			R 6 800
Total for Entire Tournament (Large in Learner Numbers)			R 11 400

In addition, where savings have been made during the year, TDL provides certificates and chocolates to learners who perform outstandingly in a specific tournament. The cost of certificates for the top 10 schools and top 10 speakers come to R 140 per tournament, and chocolates come to R 150 per tournament.

Weekly Workshops Budget Breakdown

A week of TDL workshops includes transport for volunteer coaches from the various campuses (UCT, UWC, CPUT) to the school and back. This takes the form of a Uber XL if the number of volunteers is low, or a bus if there are either a large number of volunteers or TDL is able to share the cost of transport with another Ubunye project.

The breakdown is listed below for a **typical week of TDL workshops** is listed below.

Day of the Week	Description	Cost per learner	Cost
Saturday	10 schools travel to the University of Cape Town for training.	R15	R 1500
	Learner refreshments	R20	R 2000
Total			R 3500

Therefore, we estimate that each workshop could be around **R3500**. This year, we aim to have 6 workshops and 3 tournaments.

In addition, TDL has in the past received funding directed towards **specific schools** that we work with. For instance, funding the weekly workshops at Heideveld Secondary School for one week amounts to R 300, as the volunteers from UWC are located near to the school. Funding weekly workshops for a month at Heideveld thus amounts to R 1 200. Finally, Four weeks of workshops, attendance for 5 Heideveld Junior learners and 5 Senior learners at one tournament amounts to R 1 750.

OUR CURRENT VENDORS

We have two vendors who provide us with food and transport respectively. Transport is provided by *Mdu's Transport*, a private transport company, who send a bus on weekdays to UCT to take our volunteers to the schools. On tournament weekends they also provide transport for volunteers to and from the tournament venue. Sometimes we get a Uber when there are few volunteers who need transport. This is cheaper and more flexible, but without the assurance and safety which *Mdu's* provides.

Mdu's Transport
Email: mdustransport@telkomsa.net
Phone no: 0213938551

Food is provided by *Lavender Moon Trading*, a small private catering company. They provide us with lunch packs for the learners and volunteers for weekend tournaments at a very good price (R25 per person).

Lavender Moon Trading
Email: lavendermoontrading254@gmail.com
Phone no: 0728452756

While these are the vendors we usually use, it would not be too difficult for us to use different services for a sponsored event if necessary.

Our Banking details

Bank account name: UCT Sundries Account
Account number: 071503854
Bank: Standard Bank
Branch: Rondebosch, code 025009
Reference: Fund no. 672067

Other details

Gmail: tdluct@gmail.com

Director: Natalie Jacobs
Cell: 062 595 0155

Deputy Director & Fundraising Coordinator: Jonathan Shiferaw
Cell: 074 799 0271

Please feel free to contact either of us on WhatsApp or by email. Unfortunately, we're unlikely to pick up calls during the day due to lectures.